TECHNOVA SOLUTIONS PVT. LTD.

PROMOTION & CAREER DEVELOPMENT POLICY

Document ID	TN-HR-POL-007
Document Type	Promotion & Career Development Policy
Policy Owner	Human Resources
Approving Authority	Executive Management
Classification	Internal — Employee Access
Version	1.0
Effective Date	01 April 2026
Review Cycle	Annual
Status	Active
Supersedes	New Policy

1. Purpose

This Promotion & Career Development Policy establishes the framework used by TechNova Solutions Pvt. Ltd. (“TechNova” or “the Company”) to support employee career growth, internal mobility, promotions, expanded responsibilities, and professional development.

The policy is intended to make career progression transparent, role-focused, evidence-based, and aligned with the Company's organizational needs.

2. Scope

This policy applies to eligible TechNova employees participating in career development, internal mobility, promotion, or advancement processes.

Certain career programs may have additional eligibility requirements based on department, job family, level, or business needs.

3. Career Development Principles

- Career development is a shared responsibility between employees, managers, and Human Resources.
- Promotion is based on demonstrated readiness for the responsibilities of the next role or level, not tenure alone.
- Employees should have reasonable visibility into development expectations for their roles.
- Development opportunities should be allocated using legitimate business and development considerations.
- Performance history is an important input but does not automatically guarantee promotion.
- Career discussions and promotion decisions should be handled confidentially.
- Managers should provide constructive feedback about readiness and development gaps.

4. Career Framework

TechNova maintains job families and levels to provide a common framework for understanding responsibilities, skills, scope, and career progression.

Career Track	Typical Scope
Individual Contributor	Technical, professional, specialist, or functional expertise without primary people-management responsibility
People Manager	Direct management, team leadership, performance management, workforce planning
Technical Leadership	Architecture, technical direction, engineering standards, and cross-team technical influence
Functional Leadership	Strategic or operational leadership within a specialized business function

5. Career Levels

Career levels may differ by job family. The following general progression model may be used as a reference:

Level	General Description
L1 — Associate	Developing professional who performs defined responsibilities with guidance.
L2 — Professional	Independently performs core role responsibilities and contributes reliably to team outcomes.
L3 — Senior Professional	Demonstrates strong expertise, handles complex work, and supports other team members.
L4 — Lead	Owns significant workstreams, provides direction, and influences outcomes beyond an individual assignment.
L5 — Principal / Manager	Provides broad technical, functional, or people leadership and handles substantial organizational scope.
L6 — Senior Leadership	Leads major functions, programs, or organizational responsibilities with strategic impact.

6. Promotion Eligibility

Employees may be considered for promotion when there is evidence that they are consistently operating at or are demonstrably ready for the responsibilities of the proposed next level.

Typical considerations include:

- Sustained performance
- Demonstrated role competencies
- Scope and complexity of work
- Quality and consistency of outcomes
- Leadership or influence appropriate to the next level
- Technical or functional expertise
- Collaboration and Company values
- Business need and organizational structure

Eligibility does not guarantee promotion.

7. Minimum Expectations

A promotion recommendation should normally be supported by a sufficient period of demonstrated performance to evaluate readiness. There is no automatic promotion based solely on length of service.

Employees with active, unresolved serious performance concerns may not be recommended for promotion until the concerns have been appropriately addressed.

8. Promotion Pathways

- Annual promotion review during the normal performance cycle
- Off-cycle promotion for exceptional or business-critical circumstances
- Promotion following a material expansion of responsibilities

- Internal transfer combined with a change in level
- Career progression following completion of a structured development plan

9. Employee Career Discussion

Employees are encouraged to discuss career goals with their managers during regular one-to-one meetings and performance discussions.

Career discussions may cover current strengths, future interests, target roles, skills to develop, project opportunities, training, and potential career paths.

10. Individual Development Plan

Where appropriate, the employee and manager may establish an Individual Development Plan (IDP).

10.1 IDP Contents

- Career objective
- Current capability assessment
- Target competencies
- Development actions
- Learning resources
- Practical assignments
- Target dates
- Progress review dates

11. Development Activities

- Formal technical or professional training
- Certifications and structured courses
- Mentoring or coaching
- Stretch assignments
- Cross-functional projects
- Temporary role expansion
- Knowledge-sharing sessions
- Internal communities of practice
- Leadership development programs
- Job shadowing

12. Promotion Nomination

A promotion may be initiated by the employee's manager, through an established HR process, or through a formal career review process.

Employees may express interest in promotion, but the formal recommendation is normally submitted by the manager or authorized business leader.

13. Promotion Recommendation

A recommendation should explain why the employee is ready for the proposed level.

13.1 Recommended Evidence

- Summary of current responsibilities
- Evidence of increased scope
- Examples of complex work
- Performance history
- Competency assessment
- Leadership or influence examples
- Customer or stakeholder outcomes
- Development progress
- Proposed level and role expectations

14. Promotion Assessment

HR and the relevant management stakeholders may review promotion recommendations for consistency with the career framework, role structure, organizational need, compensation framework, and performance evidence.

The review should distinguish between strong performance in the current role and demonstrated capability at the next level.

15. Competency Assessment

Competencies should be evaluated according to the employee's job family and proposed level.

Competency	Assessment Focus
Technical / Functional Expertise	Depth, breadth, application, judgment
Problem Solving	Complexity, reasoning, trade-offs, independence
Execution	Reliability, planning, delivery, quality
Communication	Clarity, stakeholder management, influence
Collaboration	Team contribution, knowledge sharing, cross-functional effectiveness
Leadership	Direction, mentoring, ownership, decision-making where applicable
Strategic Thinking	Long-term impact, prioritization, organizational perspective at relevant levels

16. Calibration

Promotion decisions may be reviewed through calibration discussions involving HR and appropriate leaders. Calibration is intended to support consistency across teams and job families.

Calibration should not be used to create an arbitrary quota for promotions.

17. Approval Authority

Promotion approvals depend on the employee's level and the applicable organizational structure.

Promotion Type	Typical Approval
Within standard level progression	Manager + Department Leadership + HR
Promotion into management	Department Leadership + HR + relevant Executive authority
Senior leadership promotion	Executive Management + HR
Compensation exception	Additional approval under compensation governance

18. Promotion Effective Date

The effective date of an approved promotion should be communicated formally by HR or another authorized function.

A promotion should not be represented as final until required approvals have been completed.

19. Compensation Following Promotion

A promotion may result in a compensation adjustment according to the Company's compensation framework. The adjustment is not necessarily a fixed percentage and depends on role level, compensation position, internal equity, budget, and applicable approvals.

Compensation information remains confidential and should be communicated through authorized channels.

20. Off-Cycle Promotions

An off-cycle promotion may be considered when business circumstances make waiting for the normal annual cycle inappropriate.

Examples may include substantial permanent expansion of responsibility, organizational restructuring, critical retention considerations, or sustained demonstrated readiness identified outside the normal review cycle.

Off-cycle promotion requires the same substantive evidence of readiness and appropriate approvals.

21. Internal Mobility

Employees may apply for eligible internal positions through the Company's internal recruitment process.

Internal mobility decisions should consider role requirements, employee capability, performance, business needs, and transition requirements.

22. Lateral Career Moves

Career development does not always require promotion. Employees may move laterally to develop new skills, enter another job family, broaden business knowledge, or pursue a different career path.

A lateral move may occur without a change in level or compensation, subject to the applicable role framework.

23. Temporary Expanded Responsibilities

An employee may temporarily perform responsibilities beyond their normal role for project, absence coverage, or development purposes.

Temporary responsibility does not automatically constitute a promotion. Where the expanded responsibility becomes permanent, the role and level should be reviewed.

24. Acting Roles

An employee may be assigned to act in a leadership or specialist capacity for a defined period.

Acting assignments should identify the expected responsibilities, duration, reporting relationship, and any approved temporary compensation treatment.

25. Promotion Deferral

A promotion may be deferred when an employee demonstrates potential but requires additional evidence, development, sustained performance, or opportunity to operate at the next level.

Managers should communicate the principal development gaps and, where practical, provide a path for reassessment.

26. Unsuccessful Promotion Recommendation

An unsuccessful recommendation does not necessarily indicate poor performance. The employee may be performing successfully at the current level while not yet demonstrating the full requirements of the next level.

The manager should provide constructive feedback and identify development opportunities where appropriate.

27. Career Development for High Performers

High-performing employees may be offered additional development opportunities such as strategic assignments, mentoring, leadership exposure, cross-functional work, or advanced training.

Participation in development programs does not itself guarantee promotion.

28. Manager Responsibilities

- Discuss career goals regularly.
- Provide clear expectations for current and future roles.
- Identify meaningful development opportunities.
- Provide evidence-based feedback.
- Avoid making unauthorized promotion commitments.
- Submit well-supported recommendations.
- Apply the career framework consistently.
- Maintain confidentiality.

29. Employee Responsibilities

- Take ownership of career development.
- Discuss career interests with the manager.
- Complete agreed development activities.
- Seek feedback and act on it.
- Maintain evidence of significant contributions.
- Apply for internal roles through approved channels.
- Understand that promotion depends on readiness and organizational need.

30. HR Responsibilities

- Maintain career frameworks and promotion processes.
- Support managers and employees.
- Review promotion recommendations.
- Coordinate calibration.
- Maintain appropriate career and promotion records.
- Support development programs.
- Monitor consistency and policy compliance.

31. Confidentiality

Promotion discussions, assessments, succession information, compensation proposals, and development records may contain confidential employee information and must be shared only with authorized participants.

32. Appeals and Concerns

An employee who believes a promotion process contains a material factual error or was handled inconsistently may raise the concern with the manager or HR.

HR may review the process and determine whether further review is appropriate. A concern does not guarantee a change in the promotion decision.

33. Exceptions

Exceptions to standard promotion-cycle requirements require approval from HR and the appropriate business authority. Any exception should be documented with its rationale and approval.

34. Policy Violations

Managers must not manipulate promotion decisions for personal benefit, discriminate against employees, retaliate through career processes, or make unauthorized commitments.

Employees must not falsify achievements, qualifications, or supporting information.

Potential violations may be handled under applicable Company procedures.

35. Frequently Asked Questions

Does length of service guarantee promotion?

No. Promotion is based on demonstrated readiness, performance, competencies, scope, and organizational need.

Can an employee ask for a promotion?

Yes. Employees are encouraged to discuss career goals and readiness with their manager.

Does a high performance rating guarantee promotion?

No. Performance is an important input, but promotion also requires demonstrated capability at the next level and an appropriate organizational role.

Can promotion happen outside the annual cycle?

Yes. Off-cycle promotions may be considered for appropriate business or career circumstances.

Can I change departments without being promoted?

Yes. Internal mobility and lateral career moves may support development without a level change.

What happens if I am not ready for promotion?

The manager should identify development gaps and, where practical, provide opportunities to build the required capabilities.

Does promotion automatically mean a fixed salary increase?

No. Compensation changes follow the applicable compensation framework and approval process.

Can temporary additional responsibilities result in promotion?

Not automatically. Permanent expansion of responsibilities should trigger a role and level review.

36. Policy Administration

Human Resources owns this policy and reviews it at least annually or when material changes occur in organizational structure, job architecture, compensation, or career programs.

The latest approved version maintained in the official Company policy repository is the authoritative version.

37. Revision History

Version	Effective Date	Description	Owner	Approval
1.0	01 April 2026	Initial release of Promotion & Career Development Policy	Human Resources	Executive Management

38. Related Documents

- Employee Handbook
- Performance Management Policy
- Recruitment & Hiring Policy
- Employee Benefits Policy
- Leave Policy
- Attendance Policy
- Work From Home & Hybrid Work Policy

END OF DOCUMENT

TN-HR-POL-007 | Version 1.0 | Internal — Employee Access | Human Resources